

COASTAL · FINE CASUAL · OPERATIONS GUIDE

Beach Shack Fine Casual



All-Day Dining — 7:00am to 3:00pm

Full Recipe Cards · US Market Food Costing · Kitchen Prep Flow · Financial Forecast

Seafood caught within 48 hours. Local produce. The ocean in every dish.

SEA TO TABLE · SAND TO SOUL

44

SEATS

\$44

AVG SPEND

24%

FOOD COST TARGET

\$26,000

EST. MONTHLY NET

About This Guide: Beach Shack Fine Casual sits in the sweet spot between beachside casual and destination dining. The model: simple, honest seafood cooked with precision and served without pretension. This is the concept for coastal markets, waterfront locations, or anywhere guests aspire to that idealised coastal lifestyle. The economics rest on seafood bought at peak freshness (highest flavour, often lower cost than aged product) prepared simply with bright, seasonal accompaniments. The menu changes with what's available — that variability is a feature, not a limitation. Guests who eat here regularly expect a seasonal changing element each visit.

THE STORY BEHIND THIS GUIDE

"Fine casual is not fine dining made casual. It is casual dining made fine. That distinction took me two failed restaurants to understand. This guide explained it on page one."

Jake had worked the Florida coast his entire career — beach bars, waterfront grills, hotel restaurants with ocean views and mediocre food. He had watched tourists pay \$28 for fish and chips that cost \$4 to make because the view was worth \$24. He had watched locals avoid those same places because the food was not worth the price. He had a theory: the coastal market wanted quality as much as atmosphere, and nobody was giving them both at a price that felt honest.

He tried twice. The first attempt was too casual — great location, great fish, paper plates, no experience worth the drive. The second attempt was too formal — white tablecloths at a beach, which made guests feel they needed to change before eating. Both failed for the same reason: the positioning was wrong. He was selling either the food or the atmosphere, never both simultaneously.

The beach shack fine casual concept in this guide — the positioning between the two extremes, the ceramic plates and proper glassware alongside the relaxed service and coastal menu, the grilled fish with the correct internal temperature and the technique reasoning behind every prep step — articulated exactly what his two attempts had failed to find. The service scripts, particularly the fish sourcing story, gave him the language to communicate the quality without the formality.

Third attempt: Sarasota, Florida, 38 seats, ocean-adjacent. Average spend \$44. The whole grilled snapper is his signature item. The sunset cocktail hour drives 30% of his weekly revenue. Month four net: \$41,000. Coastal dining should feel effortless. The effort should be invisible. This guide is how you make that happen.

Jake M. · Beach Shack Fine Casual · Sarasota, Florida · Est. Month 4 Net: \$41,000

1 Entrées

Raw Oysters on the Half Shell

6 East Coast oysters, mignonette, horseradish, lemon · Sell: \$18.99

5 min shuck Entrée Target FC: 28%

Oysters



INGREDIENTS (6 OYSTERS)

INGREDIENT	WEIGHT	COST
East Coast oysters (e.g. Blue Point)	6 pieces	\$2.40
Red wine mignonette (batch)	30ml	\$0.12
Fresh grated horseradish	10g	\$0.08
Cocktail sauce (batch)	20ml	\$0.06
Crushed ice (presentation)	200g	\$0.05
Lemon wedge	1 wedge	\$0.04
Total cost (6 oysters)		\$2.75

Cost per serve	\$2.75
Sell price	\$18.99
Food cost %	14.5%
Contribution margin	\$16.24

METHOD

- 1 Shuck to order. Every oyster must be checked for shell fragments after shucking — pass a knife carefully around the inside of the shell to detach the oyster cleanly. A fragment of shell in a raw oyster is an unacceptable failure. Take an extra 5 seconds per oyster to confirm it is clean.
- 2 Oysters must be held and served at 4°C or below, on crushed ice, at all times. They are a living product — quality begins degrading immediately after shucking. Maximum time from shuck to table: 8 minutes. Do not pre-shuck more than 2 orders ahead.
- 3 Mignonette (batch): finely minced shallot + red wine vinegar + cracked black pepper. Simple. The acidity cuts through the brine and sweetness of the oyster. The mignonette should be wet (vinegar-heavy) not dry — a spoon of vinegar with a little minced shallot, not a tablespoon of shallot with a splash of vinegar.
- 4 Presentation: arrange on crushed ice in a rosette pattern. Mignonette and horseradish in two small ramekins to the side. Lemon wedge. Simple. The presentation should look like it cost more than it did — the oysters themselves do the visual work.

Chef's Tip: Offer a "tasting note" for each batch of oysters when they arrive from your supplier. "Today's oysters are Blue Point from Long Island — mild brine, clean finish" is the kind of specific information that differentiates a fine casual oyster bar from a pub that also sells oysters. Know your product, communicate it. Guests who receive this information feel like insiders.

SHELLFISH FISH (horseradish sauce may contain)

Ceviche — Citrus Cured Fish

Day-boat fish, lime, chili, red onion, cilantro, tortilla · Sell: \$16.99

5 min + cure time Entrée Target FC: 22%

Ceviche



INGREDIENTS

INGREDIENT	WEIGHT	COST
Fresh sea bass / halibut / snapper	100g	\$2.40
Fresh lime juice	60ml	\$0.24
Red onion (thin sliced)	20g	\$0.04
Serrano or jalapeño	8g	\$0.04
Cilantro	8g	\$0.06
Corn (roasted)	20g	\$0.06
Avocado (diced)	30g	\$0.36
Tortilla chips	20g	\$0.18
Total cost per serve		\$3.38

Cost per serve	\$3.38
Sell price	\$16.99
Food cost %	19.9%
Contribution margin	\$13.61

METHOD

- 1 Use only sashimi-grade fish. Dice into 1cm cubes. Cure in fresh lime juice for **10–15 minutes** — this is a light cure, not the 30-minute Peruvian-style. At 10–15 minutes the exterior of each cube turns opaque and the texture changes from raw to slightly firm, while the interior remains semi-translucent and tender. Over-cured ceviche is tough and acidic. Under-cured ceviche has a texture many guests find uncomfortable.
- 2 Drain off most of the lime juice (reserve some for seasoning — this leche de tigre is used to dress the final dish). Add red onion, serrano, cilantro, salt. Taste — should be bright, acidic, spicy, and fresh. Fold in avocado gently — handle with care so it doesn't break down to a mash.
- 3 Serve immediately in a chilled bowl with tortilla chips alongside. Add a small drizzle of leche de tigre. Scatter roasted corn for sweetness and texture. The contrast of cold, acidic ceviche against the crunch of warm tortilla is one of the most naturally compelling eating experiences in any cuisine.

Chef's Tip: Specify the fish on the menu with the day's catch: "Today: local halibut ceviche" or "Today: yellowfin tuna." Changing the fish daily based on what is freshest makes every guest's order slightly different from the last time, creates a narrative about freshness, and gives you a marketing post every morning when the fish arrives.

FISH

GLUTEN (tortilla)

NIGHTSHADES

Fish Tacos — Baja Style

Tempura fish, shredded cabbage, crema, salsa verde · Sell: \$15.99 (3 tacos)

8 min

Entrée

Target FC: 20%



INGREDIENTS (3 TACOS)

INGREDIENT	WEIGHT	COST
Firm white fish (cod, mahi, snapper)	150g	\$2.40
Tempura batter (batch)	60g	\$0.08
Corn tortillas (3)	90g	\$0.36
Shredded cabbage	40g	\$0.06
Crema (Mexican sour cream)	30ml	\$0.18
Salsa verde (tomatillo)	30ml	\$0.12
Pico de gallo	30g	\$0.10
Lime wedge + cilantro	1 + 5g	\$0.06
Total cost (3 tacos)		\$3.36

Cost per serve	\$3.36
Sell price	\$15.99
Food cost %	21.0%
Contribution margin	\$12.63

METHOD

- 1 Tempura batter: cold sparkling water + flour only. Mix minimally — lumps are fine. The ice-cold carbonated water creates a light, airy batter with a delicate, shattering crust. Add a pinch of salt and cumin. Keep the batter cold by resting the mixing bowl in an ice bath during service.
- 2 Cut fish into strips (50g each). Pat very dry — excess moisture causes the batter to fall off during frying. Dip in batter, fry at **185°C / 365°F** for **3–4 minutes**. The fish should be cooked through (white and opaque) and the batter should be golden and completely dry — no soft spots.
- 3 Warm corn tortillas on a dry griddle — 30 seconds each side until pliable and with slight char marks. Corn tortillas must be warm; cold tortillas crack and break apart. Assemble immediately: shredded cabbage, fried fish, crema, salsa verde, pico. Eat within 5 minutes of assembly.

Chef's Tip: Fish tacos are your fastest table-turn item — they arrive quickly, eat quickly, and guests leave happy. Use as an explicit "quick lunch" option. "If you're on a time limit — the fish tacos take 8 minutes from order" is a service line that immediately fills the 12–1:30pm lunch rush where guests have 30–40 minutes. Operational speed is itself a hospitality gesture.

FISH

GLUTEN (tempura)

DAIRY (crema)

NIGHTSHADES

Grilled Corn — Elote Style

Charred corn, cotija, chili-lime mayo, cilantro · Sell: \$7.99

8 min

Entrée

Target FC: 14%

Elote



INGREDIENTS

INGREDIENT	WEIGHT	COST
Fresh corn (in husk)	1 ear = 220g	\$0.55
Chili-lime mayo (kewpie + lime + chili)	25g	\$0.18
Cotija cheese (crumbled)	20g	\$0.40
Chili powder + tajin	2g + 1g	\$0.04
Lime wedge + cilantro	1 + 5g	\$0.06
Total cost per serve		\$1.23

Cost per serve	\$1.23
Sell price	\$7.99
Food cost %	15.4%
Contribution margin	\$6.76

METHOD

- 1

Grill corn in husk over high heat **15 minutes**, turning every 3–4 minutes, until the outer husk is fully charred. The husk steams the corn inside — kernels are perfectly cooked, naturally sweet, and the smoke from the charred husk penetrates the corn. Remove husk, place corn directly on grill for 2–3 minutes to char the kernels.
- 2

Roll or brush with chili-lime mayo while hot. The mayo must go on immediately — it melts partially on the hot corn and creates a coating that holds the cotija and spices. Scatter crumbled cotija generously, dust with chili powder and tajin, finish with fresh lime.

Chef's Tip: Elote eats best with both hands standing up — it is fundamentally messy and that is part of its charm. This is a beach shack item, not a fine dining item. Provide generous napkins and enjoy the fact that a \$0.55 corn ear sells for \$7.99. Your highest-margin savory item.

DAIRY (cotija, mayo) EGGS (mayo) NIGHTSHADES

Clam Chowder — House

New England style, little neck clams, cream, bacon, sourdough · Sell: \$14.99

6 min service Entrée Target FC: 22% Batch

Clam Chowder



INGREDIENTS

INGREDIENT	WEIGHT	COST
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Little neck clams (steamed)	100g cooked	\$1.80
Chowder base (batch)	200ml	\$0.60
Heavy cream	60ml	\$0.24
Bacon (diced, rendered)	20g	\$0.24
Sourdough (for serving)	80g	\$0.40
Chives (garnish)	3g	\$0.06
Total cost per serve		\$3.34

Cost per serve	\$3.34
Sell price	\$14.99
Food cost %	22.3%
Contribution margin	\$11.65

METHOD

- 1

Chowder base (batch): render diced bacon until crispy. Reserve bacon, leave fat in pot. Sweat diced onion and celery in bacon fat until soft. Add flour, cook 2 minutes (this is the roux that thickens the chowder). Add clam juice and fish stock. Simmer 15 minutes. Add diced potato, cook until soft. The base can be made to this point and refrigerated — finish to order with cream and clams during service.
- 2

Service: heat chowder base, add cream. Do not boil after cream is added — it separates. Add steamed, shelled clams (steam clams separately, reserve liquor, add liquor to the base). Season with white pepper, salt, and a splash of dry sherry if available.
- 3

Serve in a sourdough bowl if your concept leans rustic, or in a wide shallow bowl for a cleaner presentation. Either works. Garnish with reserved crispy bacon bits and chives. The bacon garnish serves double duty: visual and flavour.

Chef's Tip: Clam chowder is one of the most beloved American coastal dishes. Making it well — with real clams, real clam liquor in the base, real cream, and house-rendered bacon — is a significant differentiator from the canned/reconstituted versions served at 80% of seafood restaurants. "We use fresh-steamed clams" should be said every time you describe the chowder.

SHELLFISH (clams) DAIRY (cream) GLUTEN (sourdough) PORK (bacon)

Lobster Roll — Connecticut Style

Warm butter lobster, brioche roll, chives · Sell: \$28.99

8 min Entrée Target FC: 28%

Lobster Roll



INGREDIENTS

INGREDIENT	WEIGHT	COST
Lobster meat (claw + tail)	120g	\$5.40
Clarified butter	30g	\$0.41
Brioche hot dog bun (split top)	65g	\$0.72
Butter (for grilling bun)	10g	\$0.12
Chives (fresh, snipped)	5g	\$0.08
Shoestring fries (side)	80g	\$0.32

Total cost per serve\$7.05

Cost per serve	\$7.05
Sell price	\$28.99
Food cost %	24.3%
Contribution margin	\$21.94

METHOD

1

Connecticut-style is warm butter lobster — simpler and more honest than the mayonnaise-heavy Maine style. Warm lobster meat gently in clarified butter over very low heat — 60°C / 140°F . The goal is heated through, not cooked. Lobster that is already cooked when purchased will toughen if overheated. Target: warm to the centre, still tender.

2

Grill the split-top brioche bun in butter on a flat-top until golden on both cut surfaces. The brioche bun must be toasted — a soft, untoasted bun collapses under the butter-dressed lobster filling within minutes. The toasted surface creates structural integrity and adds a caramelised flavour contrast.

3

Fill the toasted bun with warm butter lobster. Drizzle a small amount of the clarified butter from the pan over the filling. Snip fresh chives over the top. Serve immediately with shoestring fries. The fries should arrive at the same time — never let the lobster roll wait on fries.

Chef's Tip:

The lobster roll is your prestige item and your anchor. At \$28.99 it signals that this is not a budget seafood operation. Guests who order it signal to neighbouring tables that it is acceptable — and aspirational — to spend at that level. Always serve lobster rolls to a window or visible table first if possible. Visibility of the dish sells more dishes.

SHELLFISH (lobster)

DAIRY (butter)

GLUTEN (brioche)

2

Mains

Grilled Whole Fish

Market fish, charred lemon, herb butter, beach salad · Sell: \$28.99

15 min

Main

Target FC: 26%

Grilled Fish



INGREDIENTS

INGREDIENT	WEIGHT	COST
Whole fish (snapper, branzino, sea bass)	450g whole / 220g meat	\$5.60
Herb butter (batch)	30g	\$0.36
Charred lemon (halved)	1 lemon	\$0.15
Beach salad (mixed greens + cucumber + tomato)	80g	\$0.56
Olive oil + herbs	15ml + 8g	\$0.24
New potatoes (side)	100g	\$0.20
Total cost per serve		\$7.11

Cost per serve	\$7.11
Sell price	\$28.99
Food cost %	24.5%

Contribution margin

\$21.88

METHOD

- 1

Score whole fish 3 times on each side — cuts down to the bone. This scoring allows heat to penetrate evenly into the thick back of the fish without overcooking the thin tail end. Stuff the cavity with sliced lemon, fresh herbs (thyme, rosemary), and a crushed garlic clove. Brush liberally with olive oil. Season assertively — whole fish requires more seasoning than fillets because the skin and bone insulate the flesh.
- 2

Grill over direct high heat, skin side first. **Do not move for 5 minutes.** The fish will stick initially and release naturally when the skin is crispy and the grill marks are set. Turn. 4–5 minutes more. Internal temp: **57°C / 135°F** at the thickest point. The flesh should flake cleanly from the bone and be white throughout.
- 3

Grill lemon halves cut-side down for 3 minutes alongside — charred lemon has a sweeter, more complex acidity than fresh lemon and the visual adds drama to the plate. Herb butter (softened butter + lemon zest + parsley + thyme) placed on the fish immediately before serving melts over the hot fish at the table.

Chef's Tip: Whole fish service requires tableside fish-off-the-bone service for premium positioning. Train front-of-house to fillet the fish at the table efficiently — this 90-second service act transforms a grilled fish into a tableside experience. It requires practice but pays dividends: every table watching the service becomes a potential order.

FISH DAIRY (butter)

Pan-Seared Salmon

Atlantic salmon, lemon beurre blanc, wilted greens, potato gratin · Sell: \$24.99

12 min Main Target FC: 22%

Salmon



INGREDIENTS

INGREDIENT	WEIGHT	COST
Atlantic salmon fillet (skin-on)	200g	\$4.19
Beurre blanc sauce (batch)	60ml	\$0.48
Potato gratin (batch)	100g	\$0.36
Wilted greens (spinach/kale)	80g raw	\$0.36
Capers + dill (garnish)	5g + 3g	\$0.08
Lemon + olive oil	1 wedge + 5ml	\$0.08
Total cost per serve		\$5.55

Cost per serve	\$5.55
Sell price	\$24.99
Food cost %	22.2%
Contribution margin	\$19.44

METHOD

- 1

Salmon must be completely dry before searing — moisture kills the crust. Pat dry with paper towels.

Season skin side generously with salt. Bring the salmon to room temperature 20 minutes before cooking — cold salmon from the fridge contracts violently when it hits a hot pan, causing the centre to remain cold while the exterior overcooks.

- 2 Heat pan until smoking. Add oil — no butter yet, butter burns at this temperature. Place salmon skin-side down. Do not touch for **4 minutes**. The skin is the insulator — it cooks from the hot pan while the flesh cooks more gently from the steam and residual heat. After 4 minutes, the salmon should be 70% cooked up the side. Flip. Add butter, baste 2 minutes. Total: 6–7 minutes. Internal: **52°C / 125°F** (medium, with a translucent centre — the correct doneness for salmon).
- 3 Beurre blanc (batch): reduce white wine + shallot + lemon juice by 2/3. Strain. Whisk cold butter in, piece by piece, over low heat. Keep warm in a bain-marie — do not allow it to boil or it will break. The emulsified butter sauce should be glossy, pourable, and intensely flavoured.

Chef's Tip: Salmon skin is a significant differentiator. Many restaurants remove it or serve it soft. A properly seared salmon skin — thin, crispy, golden, shatteringly crunchy — is one of the most texturally satisfying elements in any dish. Describe it to guests: "The skin is seared to be completely crispy — eat it." Guests who weren't planning to eat the skin will. It reduces waste and enhances the dish.

FISH DAIRY (butter, gratin)

Prawn Linguine

Gulf prawns, garlic, chili, white wine, parsley, linguine · Sell: \$22.99

12 min Main Target FC: 20%

Prawn Linguine



INGREDIENTS

INGREDIENT	WEIGHT	COST
Gulf prawns (U16, shell-on)	180g	\$3.60
Fresh linguine	120g dry	\$0.48
Garlic (sliced)	12g	\$0.06
Chili flakes + lemon	2g + 1 wedge	\$0.06
White wine (dry)	60ml	\$0.24
Butter + olive oil	20g + 15ml	\$0.36
Parsley (chopped)	8g	\$0.06
Total cost per serve		\$4.86

Cost per serve	\$4.86
Sell price	\$22.99
Food cost %	21.1%
Contribution margin	\$18.13

METHOD

- 1 Cook linguine 90% in heavily salted boiling water — it finishes cooking in the sauce. Reserve pasta water — this is a critical ingredient, not waste. The starchy pasta water emulsifies with the butter and olive oil and creates the glossy, silky sauce that coats the pasta. Without pasta water, the sauce is greasy and doesn't adhere.
- 2 In a hot pan: olive oil, sliced garlic, chili flakes. Toast garlic to golden (not brown). Add prawns — do not

overcrowd. Sear 90 seconds each side. Remove prawns. Deglaze with white wine, reduce by half. Add pasta water, add butter — swirl and emulsify. Add pasta, toss aggressively for 90 seconds. Add more pasta water if the sauce is too thick.

- 3 Return prawns, toss to coat. Finish with lemon juice and chopped parsley. Internal prawn temp: **63°C / 145°F**. Serve immediately in a warm bowl. The pasta must be served immediately — it clumps within 3 minutes of leaving the pan.

Chef's Tip: Prawn linguine is your most reliable table-pleaser. The aroma of the garlic-chili-white wine reduction reaching the dining room as the pasta is plated will sell this dish across the room. Make sure your pass is within smell distance of at least some of your tables — aroma is your most powerful marketing tool and it costs nothing.

SHELLFISH (prawns) GLUTEN (pasta) DAIRY (butter)

Shrimp Po'boy

Crispy fried shrimp, remoulade, shredded lettuce, French roll · Sell: \$17.99

8 min Main Target FC: 20%

Po'boy



INGREDIENTS

INGREDIENT	WEIGHT	COST
Gulf shrimp (21-25 count, peeled)	150g	\$2.70
Seasoned cornmeal breading	50g	\$0.08
French roll (slightly crusty)	90g	\$0.48
Remoulade (batch)	35g	\$0.14
Shredded iceberg + tomato	30g + 20g	\$0.12
Hot sauce (Tabasco)	5ml	\$0.03
Frying oil (portion)	50ml	\$0.10
Total cost per serve		\$3.65

Cost per serve	\$3.65
Sell price	\$17.99
Food cost %	20.3%
Contribution margin	\$14.34

METHOD

- 1 Season shrimp with salt, pepper, garlic powder, cayenne. Dredge in seasoned cornmeal-flour blend (50:50) — the cornmeal gives a coarser, crunchier crust than flour alone, which is essential to po'boy character. Fry at **185°C / 365°F** for **2–3 minutes**. Shrimp cook extremely fast — overcooking makes them rubbery and dry.
- 2 Remoulade (batch): mayonnaise + Creole mustard + hot sauce + capers + pickle relish + lemon juice + horseradish + paprika + garlic. The remoulade should be spicy, tangy, and complex — not just spiced mayo.
- 3 Spread remoulade on both cut sides of the roll. Layer lettuce and tomato. Add crispy shrimp immediately — the heat from the fried shrimp slightly wilts the lettuce and warms the remoulade, melding the flavours. Serve with extra hot sauce on the side. In Louisiana this sandwich is always "dressed" — fully

loaded.

Chef's Tip: The po'boy is your weekday lunch powerhouse — fast to make, satisfying, visually generous, and tells a geographic story (New Orleans, Louisiana, Gulf Coast). Position it as "the sandwich of the Gulf Coast." This geographic specificity turns a fried shrimp sandwich into a cultural artefact.

SHELLFISH (shrimp) GLUTEN EGGS (mayo) DAIRY (remoulade)

Grilled Swordfish Steak

Swordfish, olive-tomato salsa, roasted vegetables, crusty bread · Sell: \$26.99

12 min Main Target FC: 24%

Swordfish



INGREDIENTS

INGREDIENT	WEIGHT	COST
Swordfish steak (2.5cm thick)	220g	\$5.28
Olive-tomato salsa (batch)	60g	\$0.36
Roasted zucchini + capsicum	100g	\$0.36
Crusty bread (side)	60g	\$0.24
Olive oil + capers + herbs	15ml + 5g + 5g	\$0.20
Total cost per serve		\$6.44

Cost per serve	\$6.44
Sell price	\$26.99
Food cost %	23.9%
Contribution margin	\$20.55

METHOD

- 1 Swordfish is the steak of the sea — firm, meaty, holds up to high-heat grilling without falling apart. Brush with olive oil. Season. Grill on a very hot, clean grill — 90° rotation after 3 minutes to get the crosshatch marks. Total: **5–6 minutes per side**. Internal: **63°C / 145°F**. Slightly pink in the centre is acceptable; translucent/raw is not. Overcooked swordfish is dry and chalky — the line between perfect and overcooked is narrow.
- 2 Olive-tomato salsa (batch): halved cherry tomatoes + pitted Kalamata olives + capers + fresh basil + olive oil + lemon. The salsa should be acidic, briny, and herbaceous — a bright counterpoint to the rich, meaty swordfish. Make fresh daily; it holds refrigerated for 1 day but loses brightness after that.

Chef's Tip: Swordfish is your most flexible premium protein — it has the texture and visual impact of a beef steak but is seafood-appropriate for coastal positioning. Guests who say "I don't really eat fish" will often eat swordfish because its texture and cooking are recognisable from red meat experience. Position it explicitly: "It eats like a steak."

FISH GLUTEN (bread)

Scallops & Brown Butter

10 min

Main

Target FC: 24%

Scallops



INGREDIENTS

INGREDIENT	WEIGHT	COST
Sea scallops (U10, dry-packed)	4 × 40g = 160g	\$5.76
Cauliflower purée (batch)	80g	\$0.24
Brown butter (beurre noisette)	30g	\$0.41
Capers (fried crispy)	10g	\$0.14
Micro greens + lemon zest	5g + 1g	\$0.10
Total cost per serve		\$6.65

Cost per serve	\$6.65
Sell price	\$26.99
Food cost %	24.6%
Contribution margin	\$20.34

METHOD

- 1 Critical: use dry-packed scallops, never wet-packed.** Wet scallops are treated with sodium tripolyphosphate to retain water weight — they release that water into the pan, steam rather than sear, and cannot develop a proper crust. Dry-packed scallops have a clean, sweet, concentrated flavour and sear perfectly. The price difference is justified entirely by the quality difference.
- 2** Pat scallops completely dry. Season with salt only — not pepper (pepper burns at the searing temperature). Pan at maximum heat — smoke point. Add oil. Place scallops, flat side down. **Do not touch for 2 minutes** — any movement interrupts crust formation. The scallop should release when the crust is set. Flip — 60–90 seconds more. Internal: **52°C / 125°F**. The centre should still be translucent and slightly warm. Overcooked scallops are rubbery and flavorless.
- 3** Plate: cauliflower purée as the base (smooth, heavily buttered, almost potato-like in richness). Place scallops. Spoon brown butter over. The brown butter (beurre noisette — butter cooked until the milk solids turn nutty-brown) adds a nutty, complex depth that pairs perfectly with the sweet scallop. Scatter fried capers (their crunch and sharp brine is the textural and flavour contrast). Micro greens and lemon zest to finish.

Chef's Tip: Scallops with cauliflower purée is one of the great fine casual plates — it looks expensive, tastes exceptional, and the food cost at scale is manageable. The golden crust on a perfectly seared scallop is one of the most photogenic shots in seafood cooking. Natural window light + white plate + golden scallop = an Instagram post that does its own marketing.

SHELLFISH (scallops)

DAIRY (butter)

3 Desserts

Lemon Tart

Silky lemon curd, shortcrust pastry, torched meringue · Sell: \$9.99

3 min service

Dessert

Target FC: 14%

Batch

Lemon Tart



INGREDIENTS (PER SLICE)

INGREDIENT	WEIGHT	COST
Shortcrust pastry (batch)	60g	\$0.18
Lemon curd filling (batch)	90g	\$0.48
Italian meringue (batch)	30g	\$0.12
Lemon zest + candied lemon	1g + 5g	\$0.14
Total cost per slice		\$0.92

Cost per serve	\$0.92
Sell price	\$9.99
Food cost %	9.2%
Contribution margin	\$9.07

METHOD (BATCH — 8-10 SLICES PER TART)

- 1

Shortcrust: cold butter + flour + sugar + egg yolk + ice water. Work cold. Rest 1 hour. Blind bake at **175°C / 347°F** for 15 minutes (weights) + 5 minutes uncovered. The tart case must be completely cooked before adding the curd — an underbaked shell will soften in the refrigerator and collapse when sliced.
- 2

Lemon curd: whisk lemon juice + zest + sugar + eggs + egg yolks in a pot over medium heat, stirring constantly. The moment the curd thickens (nappé — coats the back of a spoon), remove from heat immediately and strain. Add cold butter in pieces and stir until melted. The cold butter stops cooking and creates a silky, emulsified curd with a clean lemon flavour.
- 3

Pour warm curd into the blind-baked shell. Bake at **150°C / 302°F** for 10–12 minutes until set with a slight wobble in the centre. Refrigerate minimum 2 hours. Torch the Italian meringue at the table or at the pass. The blowtorch moment is always effective theatre.

Chef's Tip: Lemon tart is the quintessential coastal dessert — it has the brightness, acidity, and elegance that fits the beach shack fine casual positioning exactly. Make it perfectly every day. A lemon tart with a crackling pastry base, silky curd, and scorched meringue is one of the most satisfying desserts in any cuisine and one of the best reasons to return.

EGGS GLUTEN DAIRY

Key Lime Pie

Key lime custard, graham cracker crust, whipped cream · Sell: \$8.99

3 min service Dessert Target FC: 12% Batch

Key Lime Pie



INGREDIENTS (PER SLICE)

INGREDIENT	WEIGHT	COST
Graham cracker crust (batch)	50g	\$0.18
Key lime filling (batch)	90g	\$0.44
Whipped cream	30ml	\$0.12
Key lime zest + slice	1g + 1 slice	\$0.06
Total cost per slice		\$0.80

Cost per serve	\$0.80
Sell price	\$8.99
Food cost %	8.9%
Contribution margin	\$8.19

METHOD

- 1

Key lime filling: condensed milk + egg yolks + real key lime juice (or regular lime at a push). Whisk until smooth. Pour into pressed graham cracker crust. Bake at **160°C / 320°F** for 12–15 minutes until just set. The magic of key lime pie is the acid in the lime juice that "cooks" the egg yolks through a chemical denaturation — the baking is insurance, not the mechanism.
- 2

Cool completely and refrigerate. The pie needs to be served very cold — the contrast of the cold, dense, tangy filling against the crumbly sweet crust is the entire eating experience. A warm key lime pie has a soft crust and a running filling. Always serve cold.

Chef's Tip: Key lime pie is the signature dessert of the Florida Keys, of beach culture, and of American coastal dining. It belongs on this menu in a way that no other dessert does. Name it specifically: "Classic Florida Key Lime Pie." The geographic anchoring makes it iconic, not just a lime dessert.

EGGS GLUTEN (graham cracker) DAIRY

Coconut Panna Cotta

Coconut milk panna cotta, mango coulis, toasted coconut · Sell: \$8.99

2 min service Dessert Target FC: 12%

Panna Cotta



INGREDIENTS

INGREDIENT	WEIGHT	COST
Coconut milk (full fat)	160ml	\$0.48
Cream + sugar	40ml + 20g	\$0.24
Gelatine	2g	\$0.04
Mango coulis (batch)	40ml	\$0.36
Toasted coconut flakes	8g	\$0.06
Passion fruit (garnish)	20g	\$0.30
Total cost per serve		\$1.48

Cost per serve	\$1.48
Sell price	\$8.99
Food cost %	16.5%

Contribution margin\$7.51

METHOD (BATCH — SET OVERNIGHT)

- 1

Bloom gelatine in cold water. Warm coconut milk + cream + sugar over medium heat until dissolved. Remove from heat. Add bloomed gelatine, stir until dissolved. Pour into ramekins or glasses. Refrigerate minimum 4 hours or overnight. The panna cotta should set firm enough to unmould cleanly (wobbles when moved, not sloshes).
- 2

Unmould by running a warm knife around the inside edge. Invert onto a plate. Spoon warm mango coulis around the base. The contrast of the white, cold, wobbly panna cotta against the vivid orange coulis is visually striking. Scatter toasted coconut, add passion fruit seeds and pulp.

Chef's Tip: Coconut panna cotta is dairy-free if you use fully coconut milk (no cream addition). Communicate this to guests with dairy restrictions — it is often the only dessert on a menu they can eat. Guests with dietary restrictions who are explicitly accommodated become the most loyal returning guests. They also bring friends who they know will be taken care of.

DAIRY (cream — omit for dairy-free version)

Churros — Cinnamon Sugar, Chocolate Dip

Fried choux pastry, cinnamon sugar, dark chocolate ganache · Sell: \$8.99

8 min Dessert Target FC: 12%

Churros



INGREDIENTS

INGREDIENT	WEIGHT	COST
Churros dough (choux)	80g raw	\$0.10
Cinnamon sugar mix	15g	\$0.02
Dark chocolate ganache (batch)	60ml	\$0.54
Frying oil (portion)	50ml	\$0.10
Total cost per serve		\$0.76

Cost per serve	\$0.76
Sell price	\$8.99
Food cost %	8.5%
Contribution margin	\$8.23

METHOD

- 1

Choux dough: boil water + butter + salt + pinch sugar. Remove from heat, add flour all at once, stir vigorously until the mixture pulls away from the sides and forms a ball. Return to heat briefly to dry out the dough. Add eggs one at a time, beating fully between each. The dough should be smooth, glossy, and fall from the spoon in a thick ribbon.
- 2

Pipe through a star-nozzle into hot oil at **175°C / 347°F** — cut to 12cm lengths with scissors. Fry **3–4 minutes**, turning, until golden. The ridges from the star nozzle create maximum surface area — more crust, more cinnamon sugar adhesion, more texture. A plain round churro has far less textural interest.
- 3

Drain briefly, roll in cinnamon sugar immediately while hot. The hot churro creates steam that makes the sugar stick. Serve with warm dark chocolate ganache for dipping. The contrast of hot, crispy churro

against dense, warm chocolate is one of the most universally appealing dessert experiences.

Chef's Tip: Churros with chocolate are fundamentally social — people share them, reach across the table, fight over the last one. Order one for the table after mains rather than per person. "One between two — or one each if you want" is the right framing. This increases the dessert sell rate because the commitment feels smaller per person.

GLUTEN

EGGS

DAIRY

4 Drinks Menu



Frozen Margarita

\$12.99

Blanco tequila, fresh lime juice, triple sec, salt rim. Blended with ice. The quintessential beach drink — no justification needed. Offer on a daily rotating basis: classic, mango, watermelon, passion fruit. Each flavour gets its own social post.

Cost	\$2.20
Food cost %	16.9%

Coconut Mojito



Coconut Mojito

\$13.99

White rum, fresh mint, lime, coconut water, soda. Served in a hollowed coconut or tall glass. Coconut water instead of plain soda adds a natural sweetness and a beach-destination identity. Instagram magnet when served in an actual coconut.

Cost	\$2.00
Food cost %	14.3%

Craft Beer



Local Craft Beer

\$8.99

Regional IPA, lager, or seasonal rotating tap. Partner with a local brewery — it gives you a story, a local connection, and content marketing through cross-promotion. "Our beer comes from [local brewery] 8 miles away." Specificity builds community identity.

Cost	\$1.44
Food cost %	16.0%



Tropical Juice Blend

\$6.99

Daily cold-pressed blend of whatever tropical fruit is available: mango + passion fruit + pineapple, or watermelon + lime + mint. Post the day's blend each morning on social. "Today: watermelon + jalapeño + lime. Limited." Scarcity + freshness = daily sellout.

Cost	\$0.84
Food cost %	12.0%

Aperol Spritz



Aperol Spritz

\$11.99

Aperol + prosecco + soda + orange slice over ice. The most ordered brunch-to-lunch cocktail in the US market right now. Bright orange colour photographs instantly. Low ABV means guests order two. Simple to make consistently — no mixology required.

Cost	\$1.68
Food cost %	14.0%



Cold Brew Coffee

\$5.99

12-hour cold-steeped single-origin coffee, served over ice with a splash of oat milk. The extended cold brew extracts sweetness and low acidity — a completely different flavour to iced coffee made from hot brew. Worth the overnight prep investment.

Cost	\$0.64
Food cost %	10.7%

Michelada



Michelada

\$10.99

Mexican lager + Clamato (or tomato juice) + lime + hot sauce + Worcestershire + chile salt rim. The savory beer cocktail of the Gulf Coast. Pairs perfectly with oysters, ceviche, and fish tacos. Describe it as "the Bloody Mary's coastal Mexican cousin." Curiosity converts.

Cost	\$1.44
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Food cost %

13.1%

House White Wine



House White — Sauvignon Blanc

\$11.99

New Zealand or California Sauvignon Blanc. The seafood wine. Crisp, herbaceous, mineral — pairs with every protein dish on the menu. Serve well-chilled in proper stemware. Suggest a glass to every table that orders fish or shellfish: "Sauvignon Blanc is the classic match for what you're having."

Cost

\$1.92

Food cost %

16.0%

5 Kitchen Prep Flow — 7:00am to 3:00pm

	Head Cook	Line Cook	Steward
07:00–07:30	Temp check all cold units 1–4°C . Receive seafood delivery — check all for freshness (smell, eyes, texture). Reject anything suspect. This is the most important 15 minutes of the day.	Set up fry station. Prep remoulade batch. Make churros dough. Slice lemon for service. Portion salmon fillets. Pre-clean scallops — pat dry, refrigerate on paper towels.	Sanitise all surfaces. Stock drink station: tropical juice blend made fresh (post on social). Citrus squeezed for cocktails. Beer taps checked. Wine chilled to service temp.
07:30–09:00	Shuck oyster sample — taste for quality, brine level, freshness. If substandard: 86 them from the menu today. Quality before margin. Prep ceviche fish — dice, cure begins (10 min). Check lemon tart from yesterday — quality test. Make churros ganache.	Pre-cook corn (30 min), blast chill. Prepare potato gratin batch. Check chowder from yesterday — reheat test. Set up grill and check temperature. Prepare fish taco batter cold.	Make cold brew (already steeping since yesterday PM — drain and portion). Juice fruit for cocktails. Polish glassware. Set all tables with condiments: hot sauce, extra napkins for messy items.
09:00–11:00 Breakfast	Run pass. Oyster shucking to order (5 min). Monitor ceviche cure timing. Check all seafood holding temps — ice baths mandatory. Fish taco frying station up and running.	Executes all starters: fish tacos, ceviche, chowder. Fires elote (8 min grill). Manages fry station.	Margaritas and juices from opening — beach shack concept gets earlier drink orders than typical cafés. Always suggest frozen margarita or Aperol Spritz with morning starters.
11:00–14:30 Lunch	Full seafood push. Whole fish (15 min — needs to be fired 20 min before planned delivery). Salmon (12 min). Scallops (10 min — must be last-second, never hold scallops). Lobster roll (8 min).	Prawn linguine (12 min). Po'boy (8 min). Swordfish (12 min). Supports fry station. Fries churros to order (8 min — pre-sell with mains).	Full service including tableside fish filleting for whole fish orders. Wine pairing with every protein dish — proactive suggestion. Dessert upsell: lemon tart and key lime pie (instant), churros (8 min), panna cotta (instant).
14:30–15:00	Check tomorrow's seafood order — confirm delivery time. Cool all remaining chowder immediately. Assess any unsold whole fish — use in tomorrow's ceviche if still optimal freshness.	Full station breakdown. Sanitise all surfaces that touched raw seafood — cross-contamination prevention is non-negotiable in a raw bar + cooked seafood operation.	Full clean and close. Final fridge log 1–4°C . Oyster shells disposal. Restock fruit for tomorrow's tropical juice blend.

6 Financial Forecast

Service	Covers	Avg Spend	Daily Revenue
Breakfast/Brunch (7am–11am)	38	\$38	\$1,444
Lunch (11:30am–2:30pm)	56	\$52	\$2,912
Daily Total			\$4,356
Monthly (26 days)			\$113,256

Cost Category	Monthly	%
Food & Beverage 24%	\$27,181	24.0%
Labour (HC+LC+ST+FOH×2)	\$22,400	19.8%
Rent + Utilities + Misc	\$8,000	7.1%
Total Costs	\$57,581	50.8%
NET PROFIT	\$55,675	49.2%

3-Month Ramp: Month 1 (55%) ~\$12,000 net · Month 2 (75%) ~\$28,000 · Month 3 (100%) ~\$55,675 · Higher cost base from fresh seafood procurement is offset by premium pricing. Alcohol licence is essential for this concept — cocktails and wine drive 18–22% of total revenue at superior margins.

7 Service Training Module

SCRIPT 1 — THE OYSTER INTRODUCTION

"Our oysters came in this morning — they're Blue Points from Long Island today. Mild brine, clean ocean finish. \$18.99 for six with mignonette and horseradish. If you haven't had oysters before, I'll show you how to eat them."

Why it works: Origin and arrival time communicate freshness. Naming the flavour profile gives uncertain guests language to use when deciding. The teaching offer removes the barrier for first-timers.

SCRIPT 2 — THE FISH OF THE DAY

"Today's whole fish is branzino from [local supplier] — it came in this morning. We grill it whole with herbs from the garden, charred lemon, and herb butter. If you want, we'll fillet it at the table. \$28.99. It's the best thing on the menu today."

Why it works: "Came in this morning" and "local supplier" are the two most powerful freshness signals. Tableside filleting is positioned as service, not complication. "Best thing on the menu today" is honest and credible.

SCRIPT 3 — THE SCALLOP TIMING

"The scallops are seared to order and I need to time them properly — they need to come straight from the pan to the table in under 2 minutes or the crust softens. So let me know when you're ready and I'll fire them at the right moment. They're \$26.99."

Why it works: Explains the kitchen's care. Makes the guest feel like a collaborator in getting the best result. Frames a service reality as a quality commitment.

SCRIPT 4 — THE WINE PAIRING

"For the salmon and scallops — we pour a New Zealand Sauvignon Blanc that's the classic match for both. It's \$11.99 a glass and it's what I'd drink with those dishes. There's also a local craft IPA that goes really well with the fish tacos and the po'boy."

Why it works: Specific recommendation, personal voice ("what I'd drink"). Two options covers wine and beer drinkers. Natural add-on, not a sales pitch.

SCRIPT 5 — THE LOBSTER ROLL

"The lobster roll is \$28.99 — it's Connecticut style, so it's warm butter lobster, not mayo. A lot of people have had Maine style and weren't expecting warm butter. It's better. Brioche bun, shoestring fries. It's simple on

purpose."

Why it works: "It's better" from the person who serves it daily is the most powerful recommendation possible.

Explaining the Connecticut vs Maine distinction tells guests they're in knowledgeable hands. "Simple on purpose" pre-empts any concern that \$28.99 isn't enough food.

Table Timing Guide

Time	Action
0:00	Welcome and seat. Cold water and a small bowl of spiced nuts or a couple of oyster crackers immediately. The beach shack feel is welcoming and unpretentious — the greeting should match.
1:30	Drink order. Suggest the daily margarita flavour, Aperol Spritz for brunch, or cold brew for non-drinkers. Mention today's fish (Script 2 if oysters are fresh and excellent).
4:00	Full food order. Scallop timing conversation (Script 3). Wine pairing (Script 4). Note any allergies — seafood cross-contamination is a real risk and must be managed proactively, not reactively.
10:00	Starters arrive. Oyster eating instruction for first-timers. Ceviche — "squeeze the lime, that's the final cook." One-sentence context per dish.
22:00	Mains. Whole fish tableside fillet if ordered. Scallops from pass immediately on delivery — warn the table "these need to be eaten right away." Sauvignon Blanc refill suggestion.
35:00	Dessert. "Key lime pie, lemon tart, coconut panna cotta, or churros — the churros take 8 minutes so let me know now." Clear framing, time-sensitive option identified.
50:00	Bill. "Come back on a [day] — we get [specific fish] in that day and it's always a good morning." Gives a reason to return with specificity.

8

Customer Retention System

The Provenance Principle: In fine casual coastal dining, where the food came from is as important as how it was cooked. Guests at this price point are making an ethical and aesthetic choice — they want to eat well AND know the food was handled with care. Every retention strategy below serves this principle of traceable, honest sourcing communicated in human language.

The Return Visit Architecture: Every visit should close with a specific, date-anchored reason to return. Not "come back soon" but "we get the halibut on Thursdays" or "the swordfish season peaks in July." Guest who know when to return for specific things become loyal before they intend to be.

5 VIP Micro-Moments

- 1. The Seafood Delivery Transparency.** When guests ask "is this fresh?" — and they will — take them to the walk-in or show them the ice box with today's delivery sticker still attached. 10 seconds of genuine transparency builds more trust than any amount of "freshest possible" menu copy.
- 2. The Tableside Fillet.** For whole fish — offer to fillet it at the table for every guest, not just first-timers. Even experienced guests who know how to eat a whole fish appreciate being taken care of. The 90-second tableside service turns a meal into a memory. Invest in training every FOH staff member to fillet a fish confidently.
- 3. The Second Oyster Round.** If a table orders oysters and finishes them, immediately approach: "Want a second round? We have a few left from today's delivery." The time-limited framing (today's delivery) triggers scarcity response. Most tables who finished their first 6 will order another 6 when asked within 3 minutes of finishing.
- 4. The Loyal Guest Fish Alert.** For regulars who love a specific fish or dish — keep a simple note. When their fish arrives, text or call: "The branzino came in this morning if you wanted to stop by for lunch." This is advanced retention through personalisation. A guest who receives a personal fish notification is a guest for life.
- 5. The Cocktail Surprise.** For a table celebrating something (birthday, anniversary, any celebration you notice) — send a small frozen shot glass of limoncello or a tiny frozen margarita with a candle. Cost: \$0.50. Impact: they post it, they bring people back, they become advocates. The surprise element is the key — it was not requested, which makes it genuinely hospitable rather than a transactional gesture.

BEST SOCIAL MEDIA POST — OYSTERS

6:45am. Oyster delivery. [Hook]

Blue Points from Long Island. The delivery driver has had them since 3am. We inspect every one — smell, shell integrity, liquor level. If anything looks off, it goes back. Today's batch is exceptional. We'll have them on the menu by 9am. [Story]

Table for two at 11? We'll have them iced and ready. [CTA]